

NIKITA RAI

+44-7435372268 | nikita.rai1203@gmail.com | UK | linkedin.com/in/nikitarai1203/

Professional Summary

Risk, Controls and Compliance Audit manager with 12+ years of global experience, MBA from The University of Edinburgh and CA from ICAI. Expertise in SOX compliance, audit standards, enterprise risk management (ERM), and 3 Lines of Defence frameworks. Delivered \$7M+ in monetary recoveries through systematic controls testing across projects valuing \$2M-\$372M across EMEA. Built SOX-compliant control frameworks reducing gaps by 60% and led 13-member finance team. Proven ability to execute end-to-end audits, assess control effectiveness, drive remediations, and deliver impactful findings to board-level committees across global operations. Cross industry expertise spanning global technology MNCs, media-tech SaaS, and agritech retail with varied business models from subscription-based to cash-intensive operations.

Key Skills

Risk Controls & Audit: Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) | IIA Standards | Risk-Based Scoping & Assessment | GRC Systems (Audit Board) | Contract Compliance | Project Management | Internal Controls Design & Testing | Cross-Functional Team Leadership | T&Cs Review | Fraud Detection & Prevention | Stakeholder Management | Audit Lifecycle | COSO Principles | Audit & Risk Committee Reporting

ISO Standards & Compliance: ISO Audit Support (ISO 27001, 9001, 31000, 19011, 37301, 28000) | Familiarity with Environmental, ISO 55000 | SOX Compliance | GDPR | Regulatory Compliance | Sanctions & Export Controls |

Finance: Budgeting | Forecasting | Financial Reporting | MIS Reporting | IFRS | Cost Analysis | Variance Analysis | Internal Financial Controls (IFC) | GAAP | Cash Flow management | Authorization matrix

Technical Tools: Microsoft Office | Data Analysis & Visualization (AI, Power BI, Tableau) | AI-Powered GRC Tools | GRC Platforms | ERP Systems (SAP) |

Professional Experience

Senior Internal Audit Manager: Risk & Customer Audit Specialist (EMEA)|Oct 2022-Present
Intel Corporation (UK) Ltd

- Owned and executed audits including on-site **process walkthroughs and internal control effectiveness** assessment across EMEA and Asia, providing **assurance on processes, controls, risk management** evaluating regulatory compliance, fraud prevention, sanctions, export controls
- Conducted retail partner rebate audits**, validating rebate payments and assessing reporting controls& risks of multi-channel retailers and their branches in the EMEA region
- Performed risk-based scoping by analysing large data sets through internal **dashboards, AI powered tools**, and external sources to assess control risks for **projects valuing between \$2 mil and \$372 mil**
- Developed dashboards and reporting templates to improve audit process efficiency**; streamlined and revised audit methodologies with updated process documentation to enhance consistency and quality
- Achieved **\$80k to \$6.85 mil in audit recoveries** through systematic identification of **non-compliance**, control deficiencies, and recommendations of corrective actions as required
Intel Customer Audit Recognition awarded: Significant Audit Findings 2025
- Designed and documented SOX-compliant control testing frameworks**, audit procedures, and test of controls **tailored to complex business processes**
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to **assess risks across P2P, O2C, and R2R cycles, conduct root cause analysis, identify systemic issues**, and develop enterprise-wide control improvement.
- Led strategic advisory engagements and consulting projects including process improvement, **fraud investigation escalations, cost benefit analysis, operation risk assessment for government tenders** and high-value Intel components
- Designed and conducted training/learning sessions** for junior auditors across the globe through real cases to improve audit methodology, control testing approaches, identify control gaps, assess risk tolerance, and design tests of controls
- Prepared high-impact, **executive level audit reports** for senior management and **board-level compliance committees** with control gaps analysis, risks insights and risk mitigation recommendations

- Cleared Intel audit training exam proving full operational effectiveness within 3.5 months versus a typical 6-month ramp-up period

Finance Manager | Sep 2020 - Sep 2021

Clover Ventures Pvt Ltd

Agritech retail startup in Bangalore connecting farmers directly to consumers and B2B clients (hotels, caterers, supermarkets) through online platform and supply chain operations. High-growth, cash-intensive business requiring strong financial controls across multi-state operations

- **Led 13-member finance team** managing ₹100M+ multi-channel revenue
- **Designed SOX-compliant internal controls framework** from ground up (segregation of duties, authorization matrices, financial reporting); **reduced control gaps by 60%**
- **Assessed and strengthened controls across key business cycles including Procure to Pay (P2P) and Order to Cash (O2C) processes**
- Managed **cash flow, forecasting and liquidity** across 3 banks; optimized cash positioning for seasonal working capital
- **Managed co-source audit relationships with BDO and Grant Thornton**, coordinating audit planning, fieldwork allocation, and deliverable quality to maximise value from external support
- **Detected and addressed ₹0.6M fraud** through control framework
- Delivered Series B reporting, **burn rate analysis, 13-week cash flow projections**, and investor MIS

Finance Manager | Mar 2017 - Aug 2020

Quintype Technologies Pvt Ltd (Quintype Inc)

New York-headquartered media-tech SaaS company providing digital publishing platform to 300+ publishers globally with subscription-based revenue model. Managed financial operations including investor relations, Series B due diligence coordination, and recurring revenue accounting for high-growth startup.

- Managed end-to-end accounting and financial processes including **Record to Report (R2R) and P2P cycles, ensuring accurate revenue recognition and timely month-end close**
- **Managed financial planning, budgeting, and reporting** for ₹80M+ turnover.
- **Reduced costs by 25% and working capital cycle by 15% via contract review, negotiations and restructuring**
- Established internal control framework over financial reporting covering revenue recognition, expense authorization, and month-end close; **reduced material weaknesses by 30%**
- Owned consolidated reporting **under US GAAP and IFRS-aligned statutory reporting**, including revenue recognition for subscription-based SaaS model, deferred revenue accounting, and investor reporting.
- Oversaw **statutory/internal audits as primary external auditor liaison; coordinated audit queries ensuring timely completion (KPMG)**
- **Managed vendor payment cycles** and credit term negotiations; recovered ₹3.8M through escalation resolution

Education

MBA, The University of Edinburgh | 2021-2022

Specializations: Strategy, Operational Improvement, Finance

Chartered Accountant (CA), The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) | 2008-2012

Integrated Professional Competency Course | Common Proficiency Test